

The Feelings List

Most adults work with about a dozen feeling words. Scan slowly and let your body respond before your mind does. The word that is uncomfortable to claim is often the right one.

Fear

Anxious	Hesitant
Nervous	Doubtful
Worried	Insecure
Uneasy	Pressured
Apprehensive	Overwhelmed
Dread	Rattled
Panicked	Shaky
Alarmed	Frozen
Threatened	Paralyzed
Unsafe	Tense
Exposed	Terrified

Anger

Irritated	Provoked
Annoyed	Fed up
Impatient	Bristling
Frustrated	Short-tempered
Agitated	Stubborn
Resentful	Hostile
Bitter	Spiteful
Jealous	Outraged
Betrayed	Furious
Defensive	Livid
Indignant	

Sadness

Down	Mournful
Flat	Sorrowful
Discouraged	Melancholy
Disappointed	Nostalgic
Defeated	Homesick
Hopeless	Tearful
Lonely	Drained
Forgotten	Burdened
Hurt	Empty
Heartbroken	Numb
Grieving	

Shame and guilt

Embarrassed	Rejected
Awkward	Unseen
Self-conscious	Silenced
Ashamed	Small
Humiliated	Inferior
Guilty	Inadequate
Remorseful	Unworthy
Regretful	Fraudulent
Blamed	Self-critical
Judged	Unlovable

Joy

Happy	Hopeful
Delighted	Optimistic
Amused	Grateful
Playful	Relieved
Lighthearted	Proud
Excited	Confident
Thrilled	Triumphant
Eager	Fulfilled
Enthusiastic	Energized
Inspired	Alive

Calm and connection

Calm	Trusting
Peaceful	Open
Settled	Warm
Content	Tender
Relaxed	Connected
Present	Compassionate
Grounded	Accepted
Steady	Supported
Patient	Loved
Safe	Curious

Where you feel it

Feelings show up in the body first. Find the sensation, then go back to the families above to name it.

Tight Heavy Hollow Buzzing Fluttery Knotted Clenched Numb Tingling Pounding Racing Restless Shaky
 Flushed Sweaty Cold Warm Light Expanded Sinking Aching Dull Still Flowing Soft Pressure
 Shallow breath Dry mouth Lump in throat Stomach drop Tight jaw Raised shoulders Heavy limbs Held breath
 Warm chest Butterflies

How to use this list. Pause. Scan the six families without hurrying. Notice which words your body reacts to. Choose the one that fits most closely, even if it is not the one you expected. Naming it is the first step. Nothing needs fixing yet.